



eye SPY!

A three-in-one workshop on setting up your Web cam to broadcast images, work as a security device, and take still photographs

Connecting a Web cam to your PC used to be a complicated task, what with the dedicated cards or parallel ports. Today, however, most cameras are USB compatible (USB is a faster data communications port best suited for video) and come bundled with manuals, supporting software

the camera and cannot be removed. In case of combo cameras, which are used as still cameras, video cameras and Web enabling devices, the chord is detachable.

Once you have successfully installed the camera, all you need to do is install the appropriate drivers and software. When you boot your computer after installing the hardware, the operating system will detect the new hardware that's connected. The OS will then take you through the process of setting up the drivers for the camera. If your camera is not detected, install the software application that accompanies your camera. This should help you install the drivers automatically. If the device you bought did not have any accompanying driver CDs, log on to www.drivershq.com and try locating the specific driver for your camera or a generic driver.

After the hardware and software are in place, check the equipment. Launch the software that accompanies your camera and see if you are able to view the image that is being captured by the camera. Adjust the settings to your requirements—they are more or less the same across all cameras. Frame rates and other cosmetic

Things you need

1. A computer with more than 400 MHz clock speed and minimum 128 MB RAM.
2. A Web camera of your choice.
3. Preferably an ISDN line (64 Kbps) since video broadcasting requires more bandwidth than normal text data transfer.

PHOTOGRAPH: Mexy Xavier

and drivers. Now, connecting your camera to your machine is as simple as plug-and-play. Your Web camera to PC connector cable will usually have a flat rectangular pin that you can connect to your computer's USB port. The other end of the chord is generally attached to